

Governance of the bank — current state

A two-page summary of where governance stands today, and the framework being drafted next.

Note on derivation (Principle 6). This presentation is a summarised derivation of internal documents. Every statement cites its source — `CLAUDE.md`, the briefs in `Team Inbox/`, or the persona files in `/Team/`. No new substance is authored at the presentation layer.

Top-of-house structure

Source: `CLAUDE.md` · `Team structure and Top-of-house reporting`.

Seat	Holder	Type	Principal accountability
Chief Executive Officer	Marc	GOVERNANCE	Ultimate executive accountability; named under the Banks Act
Chief of Staff	Scrooge	FUNCTIONAL	Orchestration of the team; never carries out work directly
Chief Risk Officer	Helena	GOVERNANCE	All risk; RAS / RAF; ICAAP / ILAAP; Board Risk Committee
Chief Operating Officer	Devon	GOVERNANCE	Operations and engineering; operational resilience
Chief Financial Officer	Camille	GOVERNANCE	Financial reporting; capital; treasury / ALM; accounting; tax
Company Secretary	Owen	GOVERNANCE	Governance machinery; statutory officer under Companies Act
Chief Compliance Officer	Zara	GOVERNANCE	RMCP under FIC; named MLRO; FAIS conduct; sanctions policy
Information Officer	Iris	GOVERNANCE	POPIA s.56; lawful-processing register; breach notification

Three lines of defence

Source: `CLAUDE.md` · `Team Inbox/2026-05-06_brief_governance-framework.md`.

FIRST LINE — RISK TAKING & OPERATING Atlas, Bea, Kai, Tomas, Imani, Sade, Niko, Yael, Ravi, Anya, Senna (build & run capacity). Builds and operates within appetite.	SECOND LINE — INDEPENDENT OVERSIGHT Helena (CRO) · Zara (CCO) · Iris (IO). Mira reports to Zara. Rohan reports to Helena.	THIRD LINE — INDEPENDENT ASSURANCE Vera (internal audit). Functionally independent; admin line via CEO with dotted line to Owen and a future Chief Audit Executive.
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Open governance seats — flagged, not yet hired

Source: `CLAUDE.md` · `Team Inbox/2026-05-06_role-brief_chief-risk-officer.md §11`.

CISO Above Senna · cyber resilience under Joint Standard 1 of 2024	General Counsel Above Imani · legal risk; contractual governance	Chief Audit Executive Above Vera · third-line independence; Audit Committee functional reporting	CHRO Above Sade · people governance; remuneration; fit-and-proper
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Engineering vs governance — a structural commitment

Engineers **build** coded controls, projections, and platform components. Governance seats hold **named regulatory accountability** and oversee the engineers' outputs. The two are distinct seats; conflating them collapses the lines of defence and weakens regulator-facing accountability. The CRO is the first explicit case (CEO directive, 2026-05-06).

Interim governance — pending board formation

The bank does not yet have a Board, sub-committees, or external NEDs. Helena has been asked to design defensible interim governance until the board is constituted — the CEO cannot mark his own homework. This is one of three deferred questions held over for her framework draft.

The six architectural principles

Source: `CLAUDE.md` · Architectural principles. These bind every team member and every deliverable.

- P1** **Events are the only source of truth.** Balances, capital, liquidity ratios, regulatory cells — all queries over the event log. As-of replay is first-class.
- P2** **Every action traces to a source.** A versioned obligations register holds typed citations to regulator instruments and internal policy. No control without citation.
- P3** **Cloud-native; nothing manual or physical except where essential.** Infrastructure, workflows, customer interaction, and documents are coded by default.
- P4** **Security designed in from the start.** Threat modelling per design, zero trust, HSM-backed keys, secure SDLC, immutable audit, rehearsed incident response.
- P5** **Multi-currency, multi-entity, multi-country from day one.** Adding the second of any of these is a configuration change, not a project.
- P6** **Single source of truth; presentations derive from data.** `Data → Process → Standard → Policy → Presentation`. External artefacts are summarised derivations — never independent authorship.

Governance framework — in flight

Source: `Team Inbox/2026-05-06_brief_governance-framework.md`. Helena leads; Owen co-authors the machinery.

- Board composition, reserved matters, charter; conflicts and related-party governance.
- Sub-committee charters — Risk, Audit, Remuneration, Social & Ethics (Companies Act reg. 43), Nominations, Credit, ALCO.
- Executive structure and named regulatory designations (Banks Act, FIC Act, FAIS, POPIA, Joint Standard 1 of 2024).
- Three lines of defence formalised; policy taxonomy and policy governance.
- Delegation of authority — coded into the platform as event-level authorisation.
- Information flows and meeting machinery — board packs as queries (Principle 6).
- Interim governance until the board is constituted; climate & ESG governance (PA Guidance Note 1 of 2024); outsourcing & third-party governance (SARB Directive 3 of 2018).

Governance work currently in flight

Source: `Team Inbox/`.

Deliverable	Lead	Target	Brief
Governance framework	Helena	2 weeks	<code>2026-05-06_brief_governance-framework.md</code>
Risk Appetite Statement & Framework	Helena	2 weeks	<code>2026-05-06_brief_risk-appetite-statement-and-framework.md</code>
Org structure (HCM)	Sade	3 working days	<code>2026-05-06_brief_org-structure.md</code>
Client master + continuous KYC	Mira (lead), Anya, Imani	1 week	<code>2026-05-06_brief_client-master-and-continuous-kyc.md</code>

CEO decisions recorded today

Source: brief annotations dated 2026-05-06.

- Customer base perimeter — primarily South African; multi-jurisdiction work principally for clients with foreign exposure.
- Continuous-KYC signal sources — non-paid first; pipeline source-pluggable for later paid integrations.
- Continuous-KYC restriction default — deferred to the CRO and the RAS / RAF.
- Governance roles — distinct from engineering roles; the CRO is the first explicit case.
- Information Officer (POPIA) — separately hired; designation to be lodged with the Information Regulator under POPIA Regulation 4.
- Chief Compliance Officer — separately hired; named MLRO and FIC Compliance Officer; Mira reports up to Zara.
- COO and CFO — both report to the CEO; COO governs operations and platform engineering; CFO governs finance.
- Principle 6 — codified into `CLAUDE.md`.

The next governance milestone

Helena delivers the governance framework and the RAS / RAF. Sade delivers the org structure. Mira, Anya and Imani deliver the client master and continuous KYC design. From those four artefacts the bank's **second-cut governance presentation** will itself be a generated summary — by Principle 6.